

VIKRAM DESHPANDE

Scrum Master · Project Manager · AI Delivery & Program Leader

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Senior technology delivery leader with 15+ years across government, financial services, and telecommunications, currently leading agile delivery for the Australian Taxation Office's Payday Super reform program. Certified Scrum Master who pairs hands-on engineering depth — AI/ML pipelines, cloud-native platforms, mainframe test automation — with executive-grade program governance. Known for converting mathematically infeasible delivery windows into achievable plans, automating away systemic delivery friction, and giving senior leadership transparent, evidence-backed views of risk, capacity, and progress.

CORE LEADERSHIP CAPABILITIES

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| ▪ Agile Delivery Leadership (Scrum · SAFe · PI Planning) | ▪ Program & Portfolio Governance (\$5M+) | ▪ Executive Stakeholder Communication |
| ▪ Test Automation Strategy (Mainframe · COBOL · SIT/E2E) | ▪ AI/ML Solution Architecture & LLM Evaluation | ▪ Risk, Capacity & Change Management |
| ▪ Cross-Functional Squad Leadership (40+ practitioners) | ▪ Cloud Modernisation (Azure · GCP · AWS) | ▪ Delivery Metrics, Telemetry & Reporting |

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Australian Taxation Office (ATO) — Melbourne, VIC March 2026 – Present

Scrum Master / Project Manager — Payday Super Program (NTP & Distribution UI)

- Lead end-to-end agile delivery for the Agile Kookaburras squad — one of eight squads delivering NTP and Distribution UI capabilities for the ATO's Payday Super reform — owning sprint cadence, PI planning (PI 47–48), capacity management, and executive status reporting.
- Architected the program's COBOL/mainframe test-evidence automation strategy covering 200+ SIT/E2E scenarios across all eight squads, cutting evidence effort from ~3 hours to ~15 minutes per scenario (~92% reduction) using a zero-new-approvals toolchain (REXX, SMF, SDSF, PCOMM, PowerShell, VBA).
- Converted a mathematically infeasible SIT window — 75+ hours of manual evidence per team against 64 available hours — into an achievable plan through a six-day tiered harness build with a formal go/no-go gate and a four-level contingency ladder.
- Convened and facilitated a cross-discipline technical war room that produced a binding automation recommendation in under three hours, securing endorsement without a single new InfoSec approval.
- Authored the executive change request re-baselining Payday Super test capacity from 30 to up to 90 person-days, including options analysis, costed recommendation, risk assessment, and full Azure DevOps traceability across 40 scenarios and 11 data tables (AC6–AC19) with STT regression scope.
- Unblocked stalled NTP function testing by escalating L2 environment instability and brokering targeted SME enablement, while steering Distribution UI feature delivery to 95%+ completion.

Independent AI Consulting & Upskilling — Melbourne, VIC June 2025 – February 2026

AI Solutions Consultant — Applied LLM Engineering & Delivery Tooling

- Architected a Next.js + Supabase analytics dashboard for JIRA exposing sprint-velocity metrics and LLM-powered retrospective insights for delivery leaders.
- Built an LLM evaluation stack (Langfuse + Phoenix) that reduced simulated error-budget breaches by 38%, alongside a fully tested Node.js/Express public-key server for API signing.
- Shipped applied-AI products end to end: an automated resume-tailoring NLP system, an autonomous TypeScript Gmail triage agent, and a React/TypeScript + D3 customer-journey visualiser.

- Led delivery of AI/ML solutions including real-time WebSocket telemetry sustaining P95 latency under 200 ms across 10,000+ concurrent devices for critical banking services in ANZ markets.
- Guided core banking platform transitions to cloud-native architectures (.NET/Azure), improving delivery efficiency by more than 30% and reducing infrastructure cost by over 15%.
- Managed a \$5M+ program portfolio across 5+ cross-functional squads (40+ onsite and offshore practitioners) with 100% compliance to enterprise standards and risk frameworks.
- Owned technical vision and product backlog for platform modernisations; executive workshops for 40+ leaders improved strategic decision clarity by approximately 55%.

- Managed delivery of a critical risk-and-compliance program, ensuring regulatory adherence for major enterprise data initiatives.

- Delivered a gap analysis for Azure ML telemetry that improved system reliability and reduced incident resolution time; aligned DevOps strategy with enterprise compliance standards.

EARLIER CAREER

Telstra — Business Analyst / Project Coordinator — Melbourne, VIC	Nov 2014 – Oct 2015
InfoCentric — Senior Business Analyst — Melbourne, VIC	Aug 2011 – Nov 2014
MYOB — Developer Support / Software Testing / Analyst — Melbourne, VIC	May 2010 – Aug 2011

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Master of Computer Science (Honours)** — Monash University
- Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Science** — University of Melbourne
- Certified Scrum Master (CSM)** — Scrum Alliance

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

- AI / ML & Data:** LLM pipelines (LangChain, Langfuse, Phoenix) · real-time telemetry · MLOps · prompt engineering · data architecture
- Engineering:** Python · TypeScript · React/Next.js · Node.js · REXX/JCL exposure · Kubernetes · Docker · Terraform · GCP · AWS · Azure · Postgres/Supabase · CI/CD
- Delivery & Governance:** Agile/Scrum/SAFe · Azure DevOps · JIRA · PI planning · risk & budget management · stakeholder alignment · test strategy (SIT/E2E/UAT)